project, which operates under a light-governance model. The core team is led by Yossi Gottlieb and Oran Agra, who come from Redis Ltd, and aided by Itamar Haber, another company and community veteran, to manage the community. The team is rounded off by Madelyn Olson from AWS and Alibaba's Zhao Zhao, who have been actively involved in the development of Redis for several years.

Q. Can you tell us more about the changes at Redis with respect to governance?

A. It's been 12 years since Redis was first introduced; so when an open source project gets to the scale Redis is in, there is a great focus on maintaining the project to improve the code, make it more secure, run faster, etc. It becomes a burden on a single person to manage these tasks and organise the community working on them. So when Salvatore first started to discuss stepping back from the lead maintainer's role, it was important to consider what the new model would be to manage open source development for Redis.

Along with the company founders, Salvatore did feel a small group of people who had worked closely with him over the years would not only best understand the culture of the Redis project but also how and where it could be improved with community involvement. Initially, the biggest effort the new core team focused on was making it easy for community members to understand how and where their contributions would help in the development of Redis. We did feel it was important to acknowledge the milestone of the first 'community-driven' release less than nine months after the leadership change in the Redis project. What is most gratifying, aside from some significant improvements, is that there were 35 contributors to this release outside the core team members. Notably, there has been a 56 per cent year over year (YoY) increase in pull requests (PRs) created and 156 per cent PRs closed on the Redis open source Git project. There has also been an 86 per cent YoY increase in Redis project Git authors.

Q. Is the systems integrators segment important for Redis, or is dealing directly with customers preferred?

A. We sell through the channel that works best for the customer and is the most effective in the region. We sell directly and also through partners; the latter are both systems integrators and the three major cloud service providers—AWS, Google Cloud, and Microsoft Azure. As an open source company, our partner programme is dedicated to the three clouds that provide unique value propositions, both in the managed Redis services that are offered and also how they can be consumed through the cloud marketplaces. The latter have recently become an increasingly popular way for customers to both try and purchase managed services like Redis Enterprise Cloud.

Q. What is the current licensing model of Redis?

A. Redis has and always will be open source (BSD licensed). However, commercial Redis Enterprise products are closed source and require a commercial licence. The modules, which are add-ons that offer enhanced capabilities such as adding new data models to Redis, are licensed under the Redis Source Available License (RSAL) if they are developed by Redis Ltd.

Q. Does the committee or the governance body deal with conflicts in the sector?

A. One of the biggest challenges in managing an open source project is prioritising work and reviewing PRs before they are accepted. The new governance structure is enabling improvements and fixes to be addressed in an organised way alongside new advancements in the project. The core team manages the projects in both directions—first in making calls to see where the community can help and also reviewing these updates before they are merged into the code. The decisions on all these issues are taken by the core team with the guiding principles of what has made Redis popular — striving for simplicity, solving fewer problems but in a better way, and doing the right thing by default, with the ultimate pursuit of delivering speed and efficiency.

Q. How do you position Redis vis-a-vis the other competitors?

A. People prefer fast and interactive experiences, so with its performance and ease of usage, Redis is the most loved database. This has been proven for five consecutive years according to Stack Overflow's global developer survey. We have been named the most popular database for two years in a row on AWS in Sumo Logic's research. Finally, and maybe most significantly, Redis recently advanced to become the sixth most popular database in DB-Engines' independent analysis of approximately 350 databases.

I believe that Redis gets its popularity from two facts. First, it was born in the cloud, and can be easily adopted. It also can be used for a variety of applications and use cases that developers are trying to find solutions for, in an easy and efficient way. Most cases requiring real-time performance prefer Redis for its uniqueness of setting the bar for real-time to sub-millisecond performance.

Though there are a lot of people offering databases based on performance, Redis offers performance with the scalability and flexibility to be hybrid and multi-cloud. By multi-cloud, I mean, being able to have the same app in different clouds, as opposed to having different apps on different clouds. Our ability to offer geo-distribution capabilities at low local latency for the end user of an app